

Using Wireshark for Network Packet Analysis: An Overview

Wireshark is an open source tool that helps us analyse and get a deeper understanding of the traffic in our network. Let's explore how it can help us protect our data.



Cyberattacks have become common today and even the largest corporates are falling prey to them. Data is one of the most valuable assets any company or business owns and the threat to it is only going to increase in the future. Companies are investing a lot into their cybersecurity and networking teams and into research to prevent these cyberattacks. One way to do so is by analysing the network traffic.

Wireshark is a free and open source tool that is majorly used for network traffic troubleshooting and analysis. It can capture packets and give detailed insights into the communication between devices. Wireshark can help us analyse protocols like HTTP, TCP and DNS, and detect vulnerabilities and anomalies.

By analysing network packets using Wireshark, we can detect malicious activities such as intrusion and malware detection. Network packet analysis can help us troubleshoot network issues and the logs can be used to reconstruct events that led to a security incident. This tool can also be used for penetration testing to identify the weak points in a network.

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Figure 1: Wireshark installer